

MIHYUN YOU

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GEORGETOWN UNIVERSITY

Department of Economics
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Placement Director: Toshihiko Mukoyama tm1309@georgetown.edu

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Education

Ph.D program, Economics, Georgetown University, August 2020 – present

- Expected completion: May 2027
- Committee: Prof. Toshihiko Mukoyama (Advisor), Prof. Mark Huggett, and Prof. Ami Ko

M.A., Economics, Korea University, 2020

- Committee: Prof. Jinill Kim (Advisor), Prof. Dongheon Kim, and Prof. Dukpa Kim

B.A., Economics, Korea University, 2017

Research Interests

Quantitative Macro; Macro-labor; Macro-finance

Dissertation Papers

- **"Family Structure and Youth Employment Instability: Evidence on Job Quality and Match Stability" (Job Market Paper)**

Abstract: This paper studies how family structure during adolescence is associated with early-career employment instability after conditioning on observed human capital. Using weekly labor market histories from the NLSY97, I compare workers who lived with a single parent at age 16 with those who lived two resident parent figures. Workers from single parent households experience higher post-school unemployment, driven primarily by more frequent separations from employment rather than slower job finding rates. Differences in accepted matches also depend on the path into a job: jobs entered from unemployment are shifted toward lower observed quality, whereas jobs reached through direct job-to-job transitions have similar observed quality but higher subsequent separation risk.

I interpret these facts through a job-ladder model with heterogeneous wage quality, nonwage match value, and latent match stability. The model allows family structure to shift the wage-quality distribution of jobs accessible from unemployment and the stability composition of jobs accessible while employed. The estimated model reproduces the main transition and accepted-job moments, and attributes most of the aggregate employment-instability gap to reduced access to stable opportunities during employed search. Policy counterfactual exercises show that increasing unemployment resources do not close the separation gap, while expanding the overall quantity of on-the-job offers reduces it only indirectly. By contrast, expanding access specifically to stable opportunities is substantially more effective, closing the gap with a much smaller increase in total offer access. The results highlight the composition and durability of accessible jobs as important margins of early-career inequality.

- **"Work-From-Home, Worker Interactions, and Economic Growth"**

Abstract: This paper applies the dynamic knowledge diffusion model developed by Lucas and Moll (2014) to examine how worker productivity distribution evolves and how long-run growth responds to the shift toward hybrid work environments. In the model, workers differ in their productivity and allocate time between working from home (WFH) and working on-site (WOS). Productivity improves only through learning from higher-productivity workers. We incorporate a learning probability kernel based on relative productivity and empirical rate of returns of face-to-face spillovers to better capture heterogeneity in knowledge transmission. The allocation of time between remote and on-site work determines both the current level of output and the economy's long-run growth path. Through numerical simulations, we characterize the balanced growth equilibrium under various hybrid work intensities. Furthermore, we compare decentralized outcomes with the socially optimal solution that internalizes the positive externalities of knowledge spillovers. The findings contribute to the ongoing policy debate on the optimal design of remote work in the post-pandemic economy.

- **"Housing Policy, Portfolio Risk, and the Home-Purchase Threshold: Financial Risk-Taking among Young Prospective Homebuyers" (Work in Progress)**

Working Papers

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- "Effects of Expanding Free Tuition Policy of Elite Universities in the USA" with Jinxin Wu

Seminars and Conference Presentations

Georgetown University	Washington, D.C., The United States
– AMMEEGO (Annual Macro Meetings at Georgetown), 2026	
– Presentation: Family Structure and Youth Unemployment	
Georgetown University	Washington, D.C., The United States
– AMMEEGO (Annual Macro Meetings at Georgetown), 2024	
– Presentation: Work-From-Home, Worker Interactions, and Economic Growth	
Nanyang Technological University	Nanyang, Singapore
– EAUI (East Asian University Institute), 2017 Summer School Program	
– Research Topic: Asian Regional Community Building through Transitional Knowledge Exchange	
– Collaborated with international scholars on research topics	

Research Experience

Research Assistant to Prof. Toshihiko Mukoyama, Georgetown University, Spring 2026
– Project: with Prof. Minsu Chang
– Collected and constructed a state-level panel of demographic, labor-market, and establishment dynamics using data from the BLS and U.S. Census Bureau.
– Supported decompositions of employment growth into establishment entry, exit, and average establishment size.

Teaching Experience

Georgetown University	Washington, D.C., The United States
Econ Principles of Macro, Teaching Associate , Summer 2024	
Georgetown University	Washington, D.C., The United States
Intermediate Macro, Teaching Associate , Summer 2022	
Korea University	Seoul, Korea
Macroeconomics Theory, Teaching Assistant for Prof. Jinill Kim, Spring 2019, Fall 2018	

Fellowships, Honors, and Awards

Anam Scholarship (Full-Tuition Merit Scholarship), Korea University	2011 - 2019
– Awarded to the top-ranked entering student in the Department of Economics	
– Covered full tuition and provided a monthly stipend for full semesters	
Research Assistant Scholarship, Korea University	2018 - 2019
BK21 Plus Scholarship, National Research Foundation of Korea	2017 - 2018

Language

Native Korean; Fluent English
